

Post-incident review PIR-2026-018

Order Management: failed sign-ins

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 20 July 2026, Order Management experienced failed sign-ins in production (US West) for about 240 minutes. A scripted sign-in probe started failing from two regions. Investigation found that the database ran out of connections under end-of-month batch load.

Impact

Users of Order Management saw failed sign-ins for about 240 minutes. The service owner, Commerce Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:19 First signal received.
- 09:31 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:55 Likely cause identified.
- 10:14 Mitigation applied.
- 10:43 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the database ran out of connections under end-of-month batch load.

Customer impact was limited because most traffic was served from cache.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

The relevant alert had fired repeatedly the previous week and had been muted by the on-call engineer.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Add a circuit breaker and timeout on the upstream call.
- Add a synthetic probe that exercises the affected path every minute.
- Add a pre-deployment check that validates the setting against the production baseline.